

ERP

UI/UX Product Standard

Domain Standard #02 · Modern Enterprise Resource Planning

Design direction: Modern Enterprise OS · Data-rich · Modular · Intelligent · Calm

Purpose: Establish a reusable UI/UX standard for ERP products that combines enterprise-grade operational clarity with current SaaS design patterns, progressive disclosure, contextual intelligence and scalable component architecture.

Modernity rule: The generated ERP should feel like a contemporary enterprise SaaS product, not a legacy spreadsheet-heavy back office.

1. ERP Product Definition

An ERP unifies business functions, shared data and cross-functional workflows. Users move between planning, transactions, approvals, operations, finance and reporting while maintaining a consistent business context.

Core UX objective: reduce operational friction while preserving data integrity, traceability and decision context.

Primary ERP user groups

- Executives — need concise business health, exceptions and trends.
- Managers — need workload, approvals, performance and team visibility.
- Operations users — need fast record processing and queue management.
- Finance users — need precision, auditability and reconciliation.
- Administrators — need configuration, permissions and system governance.

2. Modern ERP Design Language

Style type: Modern Enterprise SaaS / Command Center

- **Visual tone:** premium, calm, precise and technology-forward.
- **Layout:** modular workspace with strong grid alignment and flexible content regions.
- **Density:** information-rich, but organized through hierarchy, grouping and progressive disclosure.
- **Surfaces:** restrained cards, subtle borders, soft elevation and clear section separation.
- **Navigation:** persistent sidebar with contextual secondary navigation where complexity requires it.
- **Interaction:** command/search-driven workflows, keyboard efficiency, inline editing and contextual actions.
- **Motion:** subtle transitions for state changes, drawers, panels and data refreshes; no decorative animation.

3. Current UI Pattern Expectations

The ERP baseline should incorporate contemporary product patterns where they improve usability.

Pattern	ERP expectation	Example
Command/search	Global search and command entry for frequent navigation/actions.	Search invoice, customer or action from one command surface.
Progressive disclosure	Show essential information first; reveal advanced fields on demand.	Basic purchase order view → advanced tax/accounting details.
Contextual actions	Actions appear near the object being operated.	Approve directly from an approval queue row or detail header.
Side panels	Use drawers for inspection without losing list context.	Open an employee or invoice detail panel from a table.
Inline editing	Use for safe, low-risk repeated updates.	Edit quantity, due date or status directly in a planning table.
Saved views	Allow teams to preserve recurring filter/sort configurations.	My Pending Approvals, Month-End Finance, Low Stock.
Activity timeline	Expose business history in chronological form.	PO created → approved → received → invoiced.
Exception-first UX	Prioritize anomalies over already-normal states.	Late deliveries and failed payments surface first.
Responsive transformation	Adapt complex desktop workflows rather than merely shrinking them.	Desktop table becomes stacked record cards on mobile.

4. ERP Information Architecture

Organize the product around business capabilities and user goals, not database entities.

- **Home / Command Center:** KPIs, tasks, alerts, approvals, exceptions and recent activity.
- **Core Operations:** sales, purchasing, inventory, fulfillment, production and service.
- **Finance:** invoices, payments, receivables, payables, expenses, accounting and reconciliation.
- **People:** employees, workforce, attendance and organizational data where applicable.
- **Planning:** forecasts, budgets, demand, supply and resource planning.
- **Reports & Analytics:** dashboards, reports, exports and scheduled reporting.
- **Administration:** organization, users, roles, permissions, workflows, rules and integrations.

5. ERP Navigation Standard

Recommended model: Global navigation → Module → Workspace → Record → Action.

- Use clear module grouping rather than a long undifferentiated menu.
- Support navigation search for large ERP installations.
- Persist the active module and workspace state.
- Use breadcrumbs only when hierarchy genuinely improves orientation; do not add them mechanically.
- Provide recent/favorite modules and records for frequent users.
- Keep global utilities—search, notifications, help, profile and organization switcher—consistent.

6. Design System Foundations

Foundation	ERP standard
Grid	12-column desktop grid with flexible workspace regions.
Spacing	4px base scale; prioritize 8/12/16/24/32px rhythm.
Typography	Modern sans-serif; 14px primary body, 12px supporting text, 20–32px page hierarchy.
Radius	6–10px controls and surfaces; avoid excessive rounded/pill UI.
Color	Neutral foundation + restrained brand accent + semantic status colors.
Elevation	Prefer borders and hierarchy; use subtle elevation for overlays and key surfaces.
Iconography	Consistent icon family with semantic, predictable usage.
Density	Offer comfortable default density; optionally support compact density for expert users.

7. Color & Status Semantics

- **Brand/primary:** navigation emphasis, primary CTA and selected interactive state.
- **Success:** completed, approved, reconciled, active or healthy.
- **Warning:** pending, approaching threshold or requires attention.
- **Error:** failed, blocked, rejected or invalid.
- **Neutral:** inactive, draft, archived or informational.
- Never encode financial, approval or operational meaning with color alone; pair color with labels/icons.

8. Dashboard & Command Center

The ERP home screen should function as an operational command center, not a decorative analytics page.

- Start with role-specific priorities rather than generic KPIs.
- Surface actionable exceptions: overdue invoices, pending approvals, stock risks and workflow failures.
- Use KPI cards only when each KPI supports a decision or action.
- Combine trend context with current value where useful.
- Allow date range, organization, location or business-unit context to be explicit.
- Use drill-down from summary → trend → underlying records.
- Provide a clear empty state for users with no activity or insufficient permissions.

9. Data Table & Workspace Standard

- Use tables for comparison, reconciliation and high-volume operations.
- Support search, filters, sorting, pagination and saved views.
- Use sticky headers for long operational tables.
- Keep primary identifying fields visually stable.
- Use column customization for expert workflows while preserving sensible defaults.
- Support bulk selection only when actions have predictable multi-record consequences.
- Preserve filters and scroll context when returning from detail.
- Show loading skeletons for predictable page structures and explicit empty states when no records exist.

10. Forms, Transactions & Data Entry

- Break complex transactions into logical sections rather than one uninterrupted form.
- Use contextual defaults and autofill when business rules make them safe.
- Show calculated values transparently; users should understand where totals originate.
- Separate editable fields from system-generated values.
- Validate tax, quantity, dates, accounting and dependency rules at the appropriate stage.
- For long transactions, provide draft persistence and clear completion status.
- Use confirmation only where the consequence warrants it; avoid confirmation fatigue.

11. Workflow & Approval UX

ERP workflows often involve multiple actors, states and permissions. The interface must make process state visible.

- Represent lifecycle states explicitly: Draft → Submitted → Pending Approval → Approved → Completed, where applicable.
- Show who owns the next action and what is blocking progress.
- Provide approval queues with priority, age, amount/risk and context.
- Allow authorized users to approve/reject with a required reason where policy requires it.
- Keep an audit trail of material changes.
- Never expose actions that the current permission model cannot execute.
- Use exception queues for items that need intervention.

12. AI & Intelligent Assistance Standard

Modern ERP products may use AI to reduce operational work, but AI should augment business judgment rather than obscure it.

- Use AI for summarization, anomaly detection, classification, forecasting assistance and natural-language search where appropriate.
- Clearly distinguish AI-generated suggestions from confirmed system data.
- Show source/context or reasoning signals where business users need verification.
- Require human confirmation for consequential financial, compliance or approval actions unless policy explicitly permits automation.
- Provide correction and feedback paths.
- Avoid anthropomorphic UI; treat AI as an operational capability.

13. Example — Purchase Order Flow

- **List:** purchase orders with supplier, PO number, status, amount, requested date and owner.
- **Search/filter:** supplier, status, location, date range and amount.
- **Detail:** header summary, line items, approvals, receiving status, invoices and activity timeline.
- **Action:** edit draft, submit, approve, reject, duplicate or cancel according to permission.
- **Feedback:** show processing state, success confirmation and any downstream impact.
- **Audit:** expose who changed the order, what changed and when.

14. Example — Inventory Workspace

- Lead with stock health and exceptions rather than only total inventory.
- Use location-aware filters and warehouse context.
- Highlight low stock, overstock, expiring stock and discrepancies as actionable states.
- Allow drill-down from SKU → location → movement history.
- Use charts selectively for trends; retain the table for exact operational values.

15. Accessibility & Inclusive UX

- Target WCAG 2.2 AA for core workflows.
- Support keyboard navigation and visible focus states.
- Ensure form labels, errors and status changes are accessible to assistive technologies.
- Do not depend on color alone.
- Maintain sufficient contrast for text, controls and data visualization.
- Respect reduced-motion preferences.
- Use plain, action-oriented language for operational errors.

16. Responsive & Multi-Device Strategy

- **Desktop:** primary environment for high-volume ERP operations.
- **Tablet:** approvals, field operations, dashboards and moderate data entry.
- **Mobile:** urgent approvals, notifications, status checks, field actions and lightweight transactions.
- Do not force desktop tables into mobile; transform them into prioritized record cards or focused detail views.
- Preserve critical actions and context across device transitions.

17. ERP UX Quality Gates

Gate	Validation question
Operational clarity	Can users immediately identify what requires attention?
Efficiency	Are repeated workflows optimized for expert users?
Data integrity	Are calculations, dependencies and system states understandable?
Permission clarity	Does the UI accurately reflect what the user can do?
Traceability	Can material changes and workflow decisions be audited?
Scalability	Does the design remain usable with large datasets and multiple business units?
Modernity	Does the UI use contemporary patterns without adding trend-driven decoration?
Accessibility	Can core workflows be completed with keyboard and assistive technology?

18. Design-Glanza Product Builder Rules

- Generate the ERP design system before generating modules.
- Use a single foundational component language across Finance, HR, Procurement, Inventory and Operations.
- Generate realistic enterprise states: loading, empty, error, permission-restricted, draft, pending, approved, rejected and archived.
- Prefer current SaaS patterns—command search, saved views, contextual actions, drawers, inline editing and progressive disclosure—when they improve task efficiency.
- Do not introduce trends merely for visual novelty; every modern pattern must serve a measurable UX purpose.
- Generate role-aware dashboards and workflows.
- Preserve auditability and business-state visibility throughout transactional flows.
- Run an accessibility, consistency, responsiveness and scalability audit before final delivery.
- Document domain-specific deviations from the global Design-Glanza foundation.

19. ERP Standard Summary

Style: Modern Enterprise SaaS / Command Center

UX model: Orient → Search → Inspect → Decide → Act → Verify

Visual priority: hierarchy → operational state → data → action → feedback

Modern patterns: command search, saved views, contextual actions, drawers, inline editing, progressive disclosure and exception-first dashboards

Non-negotiables: consistency, data integrity, permission accuracy, auditability, accessibility and scalability.

This is Domain Standard #02 for the Design-Glanza domain library. It establishes the ERP baseline while allowing product-specific research, brand systems, regulations and business rules to override generic patterns when justified.